
Where in the curriculum does transdisciplinary education take place?

To decide on the place of a transdisciplinary project within the educational curriculum, you must weigh pedagogical and practical considerations. This guide discusses various options.

Where in the curriculum should transdisciplinary education be included? This is a crucial question to ask yourself (Horn et al., 2021). There are various options to consider:

- **Intracurricular or extracurricular**
- **Mandatory or elective**
- **Bachelor's, master's, or associate degree**

Consider the educational needs, the opportunities within your organization, and the interests of partners.

Intracurricular or Extracurricular

Extracurricular options include summer or winter schools, where you can take short, intensive courses outside the academic year. Another option is an honors program that runs year-round alongside regular classes. For intracurricular possibilities, you might consider regular classes, modules, minors, or a capstone project.

Mandatory or Elective

Another choice is whether the curriculum component will be mandatory or an elective. Choosing an elective can help ensuring motivated students, as students actively have to choose it themselves. Setting admission requirements can further attract suitable students. Because transdisciplinary education is beneficial for all students, it can also be a mandatory component. This way, you encourage all students to collaborate and explore different perspectives.

Bachelor's or Master's

You can also choose between the bachelor's or master's level. In transdisciplinary education at the bachelor's level, students develop a broad perspective and important skills early in their studies, which they carry forward into the rest of their (academic) careers. At the master's level, they further expand their expertise and focus on complex problems. In a bachelor's program, the education tends to be of a more introductory and exploratory nature, while in the master's program, the content is likely to be more complex and in-depth. The choice to include transdisciplinary education in a bachelor's or master's program thus depends on the program's objectives, the intended learning outcomes, and the prior education of the students.

Ensure that the choices align with the participants' scheduling possibilities—students, teachers, researchers, and external partners. It's also essential to consider whether all participants can be present simultaneously. In a short-term project, it is often easier to gather all participants at the same time, fostering equality. Longer projects are more challenging to organize but allow for more depth and development.